

MUSTAPHA ABDULLAHI

Espoo, Finland

✉ mustapha.abdullahi@aalto.fi

🌐 <https://mustious.github.io>

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🌐 [Mustapha Abdullahi](#)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Large Language Models, Adaptive Computation, and Efficient Inference

EDUCATION

Aalto University & Finnish Center of Artificial Intelligence (FCAI) April 2024 - Present
PhD Artificial Intelligence Espoo, Finland

Supervisors: **Prof. Eric Malmi** & **Prof. Pekka Marttinen**

Queen Mary University of London Sept. 2022 - Sept. 2023
MSc Artificial Intelligence [Computer Vision and Robotics] - Grade: 80% (Distinction) London, U.K.

Ahmadu Bello University Oct. 2015 - Nov. 2021
BEng Computer Engineering - CGPA: 4.90/5.00 (First-class) Zaria, Nigeria

EXPERIENCE

QuantumBlack AI Labs (McKinsey & Company) Oct. 2023 - Jan. 2024
Software Engineer Intern London, U.K.

- Developed a one-click CLI tool for effortless deployment of **Kedro** projects on **Databricks** Platform.

Large-Scale Data & Systems (LSDS), Imperial College London June 2023 - Aug. 2023
Research Intern [Master's Thesis] (Advised by: Prof. Bo Zhao & Prof. Peter Pietzuch) London, U.K.

- Evaluated tradeoffs among three distribution policies of MindSpore Distributed RL.

Huawei Jan. 2020 - Feb. 2020
Big Data/Cloud Intern Lagos, Nigeria

- Performed Relational Database migration using Cloud Data Migration Tool. Utilised Squoop to migrate data between Apache HDFS, Apache HBase, Apache Hive and MySQL database.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

📖 [Google Scholar Profile](#) (* denotes equal contribution.)

- [1] Quoc-Huy Trinh*, **Mustapha Abdullahi***, Bo Zhao, and Debesh Jha, "Firebolt-VL: Efficient Vision-Language Understanding with Cross-Modality Modulation," in *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) Workshops*, Jun. 2026, pp. 3654–3663.
- [2] Lukman Jibril Aliyu, Umar Sani Muhammad, Bilqisu Ismail, Nasiru Muhammad, Almustapha A Wakili, Seid Muhie Yimam, Shamsuddeen Hassan Muhammad, and **Mustapha Abdullahi**, "Evaluating Deep Learning Models for African Wildlife Image Classification: From DenseNet to Vision Transformers," *Proceedings of Machine Learning Research*, vol. 302, Feb. 2026.
- [3] Zheyue Tan, **Mustapha Abdullahi**, Tuo Shi, Huining Yuan, Zelai Xu, Chao Yu, Boxun Li, and Bo Zhao, "EARL: Efficient Agentic Reinforcement Learning Systems for Large Language Models," *Workshop on Systems for Agentic AI (SAA), in conjunction with the ACM Symposium on Operating Systems Principles (SOSP)*, Oct. 2025.

SELECTED AWARDS

- Finnish Doctoral Program Network in Artificial Intelligence (AI-DOC) funded by Finnish Center of Artificial Intelligence (FCAI).** 2025-2028
- Finland Fellowship [for first year doctoral studies at Aalto University]** 2024
- Best Graduating Engineering Student in Nigeria, NSE (Nigerian Society of Engineers)** 2022
- 2023 Rhodes Scholarship Finalist [West Africa] - Dec. 2022**
- Google DeepMind Scholar** 2022-2023
- QuantumBlack (McKinsey Company)/Office of AI Scholar** 2022-2023
- Grand Prize Winner, Huawei ICT Competition Global Final - Cloud Track** 2020